Chen LIAN

Contact Information

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Academic Positions

University of California, Berkeley. Assistant Professor of Economics (2020–).
Research interests: Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Behavioral Economics, Finance.

National Bureau of Economic Research. Faculty Research Fellow (2021–).
Programs: Monetary Economics, Economic Fluctuations and Growth.

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA.
Ph.D. in Economics, 2020.

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA.
B.S. in Economics, 2015; B.S. in Mathematics, 2015.

Working Papers

Importing Aggregate Demand, with Dmitry Mukhin and Christian Wolf.

The Macroeconomic Effect of AI: Sizing the Software Engineering Channel, with Alex Blumenfeld, Jonathon Hazell, and Andreas Schaab.

Monetary-Fiscal Interactions: A Reappraisal, with George-Marios Angeletos, Christian Wolf, and Dalton Zhang.

Deficits and Inflation: HANK meets FTPL, with George-Marios Angeletos and Christian Wolf.

Forecasting Inflation with Microdata: An Adaptive Machine Learning Approach, with Catherine Chen, Chen Gao, Jonathon Hazell, and Lihua Lei.

HouseholdBench: Evaluating Large Language Models as Predictors of Household Economic Behavior, with Jin Huang, Diego Ferreras Garrucho, Yutong Xie, Walter M. Yuan, Qiaozhu Mei, and Jonathon Hazell.

Under Revision

Sophisticated Borrowing Constraints and Macroeconomic Dynamics, with Mahdi Ebsim, Yueran Ma, Pablo Ottonello, and Diego Perez. Revise and Resubmit at *American Economic Review*.

Fiscal Inaction as Monetary Support, with George-Marios Angeletos and Christian Wolf. Revise and Resubmit at *Econometrica*.

Borrowing Constraints, Markups, and Misallocation, with Huiyu Li, Yueran Ma and Emily Martell. Revise and Resubmit at *Review of Economic Studies*.

Publications

Why do Workers Dislike Inflation? Wage Erosion and Conflict Costs, with Joao Guerreiro, Jonathon Hazell, and Christina Patterson. *Econometrica*. September 2026.

Beliefs about the Economy are Excessively Sensitive to Household-level Shocks: Evidence from Linked Survey and Administrative Data, with Dmitry Taubinsky, Luigi Butera and Matteo Saccarola. Forthcoming at *Quarterly Journal of Economics*.

The Economics of Financial Stress, with Dmitriy Sergeyev and Yuriy Gorodnichenko. *Review of Economic Studies*. October 2025.

Can Deficits Finance Themselves? with George-Marios Angeletos and Christian Wolf. *Econometrica*. September 2024.

Bankruptcy Resolution and Credit Cycles, with Martin Kornejew, Yueran Ma, Pablo Ottonello and Diego Perez. *NBER 39th Annual Conference on Macroeconomics*, 2024.

Mistakes in Future Consumption, High MPCs Now. *American Economic Review: Insights*. December 2023.

Determinancy without the Taylor Principle, with George-Marios Angeletos. *Journal of Political Economy*. August 2023.

Dampening General Equilibrium: Incomplete Information and Bounded Rationality, with George-Marios Angeletos. *Handbook of Economic Expectations*. January 2023.

Confidence and the Propagation of Demand Shocks, with George-Marios Angeletos. *Review of Economic Studies*. May 2022.

A Theory of Narrow Thinking. *Review of Economic Studies*. October 2021 (Feature Article).

Anatomy of Corporate Borrowing Constraints, with Yueran Ma. *Quarterly Journal of Economics,* February 2021.

Low Interest Rates and Risk Taking: Evidence from Individual Investment Decisions, with Yueran Ma and Carmen Wang. *Review of Financial Studies*, June 2019 (Lead article).

Forward Guidance without Common Knowledge, with George-Marios Angeletos. *American Economic Review*, September 2018.

Incomplete Information in Macroeconomics: Accommodating Frictions in Coordination, with George-Marios Angeletos. *Handbook of Macroeconomics, Volume 2*, October 2016.

Comments and Conference Volumes

Comments on **"Fiscal and Monetary Stabilization Policy at the Zero Lower Bound: Consequences of Limited Foresight"** by Woodford and Xie, *Journal of Monetary Economics: Carnegie-Rochester Conference Series on Public Policy*, 2022.

Conference and Seminar

2027 AEA, Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland

2026 Berkeley-Stanford Macroeconomics Conference, Bravo Center Workshop on Behavioral Economics, CEMFI, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Harvard, Hydra Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics, Johns Hopkins University, Macroeconomic Relevance of Measured Beliefs Conference, NBER Behavioral Finance Meeting (discussant), NBER Ef&G Fall Meeting, NBER Long-Term Fiscal Policy Meeting, NBER Monetary Economics Spring and Fall Meetings, NBER Summer Institute (Economic Growth and Long-Run Macroeconomic Development; Impulse and Propagation Mechanism; Forecasting & Empirical Methods), Northwestern University, Ohio State University, Philadelphia Macro Workshop, Reykjavik Economic Conference, Santa Clara University, SED, SF Fed Conference on the Impact of AI on the Economy, Stanford GSB, UC Berkeley, UC Davis, UC3M, WashU & St. Louis Fed Conference on Macroeconomics

2025 AEA, Banco de Portugal, Banco de Portugal Monetary Conference (discussant), CREI, Duke University, e61 Institute, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, Federal Reserve Board, Hydra Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics (discussant), Methods and Applications for DSGE Models workshop at Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia (discussant), Micro 4 Macro Workshop, NBER Behavioral Finance Spring Meeting, NBER Monetary Economics Spring Meeting, NBER Monetary Economics Fall Meeting (discussant), NBER Summer Institute (Behavioral Macroeconomics; Impulse and Propagation Mechanism; Micro Data and Macro Models; Macroeconomics and Productivity), NSD at Peking University, SED, UC Berkeley, UC Santa Cruz, UCSD

2024 AEA, BSE Summer Forum (ADEMU), CEBRA Webinar, Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, IMF Conference on Fiscal Policy and Sovereign Debt, Imperial College London, LSE, NBER 39th Annual Conference on Macroeconomics, NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanism; Monetary Economics), Northwestern University, SED, Stanford Macro-Finance Junior Conference, The 12th Annual CIGS conference on Macroeconomic Theory and Policy, The 12th Rome Conference on Macroeconomics (Pizzanomics), UC Berkeley, UCL, UT Austin, University of Chicago (Workshop in Macro/International Economics; Behavioral Economics Seminar), SITE (Fiscal Sustainability; Psychology and Economics), Yale University, University of Tokyo, University of Wisconsin-Madison

2023 AFA (discussant), Behavioral Economics Annual Meeting, Biennial Consumer Finance and Macroeconomics Conference, Bocconi, Boston College, CKGSB, Columbia (Money-Macro Workshop and Cognition and Decision Lab), Dartmouth, Indiana University Bloomington, LAEF 2nd Annual Junior Workshop in Macroeconomics, NBER Ef&G Fall Meeting; NBER International Finance and Macroeconomics Fall Meeting (discussant); NBER Monetary Economics Spring Meeting, NYU, Psychology and Economics of Poverty Convening, SITE Fiscal Sustainability, Stony Brook Workshop on Learning and Bounded Rationality, UC Berkeley

2022 AEA, AFR International Conference of Economics and Finance, Brown, China International Conference in Macroeconomics, Conference in Honor of Marvin Goodfriend at the Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, IMF, Maryland, Miami Behavioral Finance Conference, NBER Behavioral Finance Fall Meeting, NBER Ef&G Spring Meeting, NBER Summer Institute (Behavioral Macroeconomics, discussant; Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), Princeton, SED, Stanford, Tsinghua

University, UC Berkeley, UC Davis, UCLA, University of Warwick, UT Austin, Wharton

2021 Carnegie-Rochester Conference Series on Public Policy (discussant), China International Conference in Macroeconomics, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco, Hitotsubashi University, LSE, Miami Behavioral Finance Conference (discussant), Minnesota Workshop in Macroeconomic Theory, NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), Pontifical Catholic University of Chile, SED, SFS cavalcade (discussant), UC Berkeley, USC, VEAMS

2020 Berkeley-Chicago Behavioral Economics, Boston University, Chicago Booth, Columbia, Duke, Duke Fuqua, Florida State, NBER Monetary Economics Fall Meeting, NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), BI Norwegian Business School- Norges Bank-University of Oslo, China Star Tour, Stanford GSB, UC Berkeley, Yale SOM

2019 AEA, MIT, St. Louis Fed

2018 AEA, BSE Summer Forum, Bank of Canada (discussant), D-TEA, NBER Monetary Economics Spring Meeting, NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), SED

2017 AEA, Banque de France, Cowles Foundation (Macroeconomics), ECB, NBER Ef&G Spring Meeting, NBER Monetary Economics Fall Meeting, NBER Summer Institute (Risks of Financial Institutions & Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), SED

2016 Econometric Society, NBER Behavioral Finance Fall Meeting, NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanism), SED

Conference Organization

2026 LSE Hayek Centre AI + Macro Conference (co-organizer), SED Program Committee

2025 SED Session at ASSA

2024 NBER Monetary Economics Fall Meeting

Teaching

2026 Econ 236B, Advanced Macroeconomics II

Econ 138, Financial and Behavioral Economics

NBER Behavioral Macroeconomics Research Boot Camp

2025 Econ 236B, Advanced Macroeconomics II

Econ 138, Financial and Behavioral Economics

2024 NBER Behavioral Macroeconomics Research Boot Camp

2023 Econ 236B, Advanced Macroeconomics II

Econ 138, Financial and Behavioral Economics

2022 Econ 138, Financial and Behavioral Economics

NBER Behavioral Macroeconomics Research Boot Camp

2021 Econ 236D, Behavioral Macroeconomics

Ph.D. Advising

2026 Emily Martell (Carleton University)

2023 Jianlin Wang (Santa Clara University)

2022 Seung Joo Lee (Oxford Said)

Editorial Services

2025-2026 Associate Editor, Journal of the European Economic Association

Referee Services

American Economic Review, Econometrica, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economic Studies, American Economic Review: Insights, Journal of Finance, Journal of Financial Economics, Review of Financial Studies, American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Journal of Economic Theory, Journal of Monetary Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of International Economics, Journal of Mathematical Economics, Theoretical Economics, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Economic Journal, Quantitative Economics.

Grant reviewer

National Science Foundation, Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, Israel Science Foundation

Academic Visits

2025 Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco (Visiting Scholar)

2023-2024 Northwestern (full-year)

2024 Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis (1-week), Uchicago BFI Institute (2-week), Yale Cowles Foundation (1-week)

2023 Columbia (3-week), NYU (1-week)

2022 IMF (1-week), Uchicago BFI Institute (1-week), Yale SOM (1-week)

Awards, Fellowship, and Grants

2026 Excellence in Refereeing Award, *American Economic Review*

2025 Sloan Research Fellowship

The SCOR-PSE Junior Research Prize, "Why do Workers Dislike Inflation? Wage Erosion and Conflict Costs," with Joao Guerreiro, Jonathon Hazell and Christina Patterson

Society of Hellman Fellows

2024 NBER-OFR Market Frictions and Financial Risk Grant, "The Macroeconomic Implications of Corporate Debt Contracts," with Yueran Ma, Pablo Ottonello and Diego Perez

2022 Excellence in Refereeing Award, *American Economic Review*

Excellence in Refereeing Award, *Review of Economic Studies*

CICM 2022 Best Paper Award

2021 Alfred P. Sloan Foundation: "Behavioral Macroeconomics: Methodology and Policy Implications"

Sapere Aude, DFF-Starting Grant: "The Beliefs Lab: Measuring the Evolution and Impact of Beliefs on the Economy," with Luigi Butera, Birthe Larsen, and Dmitry Taubinsky

CICM 2021 Best Junior Scholar Paper Award

2020 Robert M. Solow Prize for Excellence in Graduate Research and Teaching

China Star Tour

2019 Alfred P. Sloan Foundation Pre-doctoral Fellowship in Behavioral Macroeconomics

2017 WFA Cubist Systematic Strategies PhD Candidate Award for Outstanding Research

Date

10/06/2026